A-A-51062A
15 June 1990
SUPERSEDING
A-A-51062
15 October 1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

STERILIZER, SURGICAL INSTRUMENT

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a chemical vapor pressure sterilizer.

Salient characteristics:

The chemical vapor sterilizer shall be the following size:

Overall nominal dimensions in inches:

Width:	23
Height:	14
Depth:	19

Chamber dimensions in inches:

Diameter:	10
Depth:	16

Reservoir capacity:

Liters:	1

Operating wattage:

The sterilizer shall be capable of two processing cycles - a "normal" 20 minute cycle and a 7 minute "flash" cycle suitable for processing one unwrapped instrument in an emergency situation. Timing of the cycle shall not begin until the chamber is pressurized to 20 psig and the chamber temperature is at 132°C. The sterilizers shall operate on line voltages from 90 to 132 volts, 60 Hertz, AC, and shall be supplied with a 60-inch long 3-conductor power cord terminating in a 3-prong

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male plug which complies with American National Standard C73.11. The sterilizer shall have an operating pressure range of 20 to 40 psi and shall have an operating temperature 132°C plus 6° or minus 0°C. Prior to pressurization the chamber will be evacuated to a vacuum of minus 7 psi. Then the chamber will be pressurized with the addition of sterilant solution to an operating pressure of 20 psig plus or minus 2.5 psi. When the unit reaches 20 psig pressure and the chamber temperature is at 132°C, the timing phase will begin. After the timing phase is completed, the unit will proceed into a timed purge, during which time the vapors will be purged from the chamber.

There will be phase indicators to indicate when the unit is in the following stages of the cycle:

READY - Indicates that heaters have heated unit sufficient to initiate a cycle.

EVACUATE - Indicates the unit is in the pre-evacuation stage of the cycle.

PROCESS - Indicates the unit is in the exposure phase.

PURGE - Indicates the unit is purging.

COMPLETE - Indicates the cycle is complete and goods may be removed.

The sterilizer shall be insulated to conserve heat and prevent burns. The outer shell of the unit shall be constructed of heat-resistant thermal plastic. An aperture shall be provided to permit easy filling of the reservoir with an alcohol-based solution as a sterilant. The aperture shall be keyed with the dispenser bottle to prevent overfilling of the reservoir and/or spillage of solution. The reservoir capacity shall be one liter, which will be sufficient for approximately 25 sterilization cycles.

The sterilizer shall have a safety chamber latch to prevent the door from opening while the chamber is pressurized and shall have a condensate tray to facilitate disposal of used solution. An efficient system of condensate coils shall condense virtually all chemical vapor in the chamber during depressurization. In addition, a filtering device shall be employed to filter out any residual vapors. The filter shall be disposable and is intended to be replaced every 500 cycles.

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A cycle counter will be employed to indicate when the filter should be changed.

Sterilizer controls shall consist of the following:

- Controls OFF/ON switch
- 5 phase indicators to indicate when the unit is in the following stages of the cycle: ready, evacuate, process, purge, complete
- Two cycle selection switches for "normal" or "flash" cycle
- Two function switches for "start" and "cancel"

There will be 3 maintenance need indicators which will light on the front of the panel to indicate the following conditions:

- VAPO - indicates the sterilizing solution is low and must be replenished
- DRAIN - indicates the waste reservoir is full and must be drained
- FILTER - indicates the output filter is not in place

The control panel will contain two digital displays. The upper display will show the temperature in ^{o}C until a cycle has been started. Once a cycle starts, the upper display will display time remaining in the cycle, with the temperature displayed every 30 seconds. The lower display will display pressure in psi (may be factory set to display pressure in kPa or BAR if requested). The displays will also print error codes in the event of a malfunction.

A printer will be available as an optional item that can be plugged into the chassis of the sterilizer.

Each sterilizer shall be supplied with two copies of service data containing complete instructions for installation, operation, maintenance, a list of component parts, and wiring diagrams.

All items shall conform to the requirements of UL544 and shall be approved as conforming to that standard by an independent nationally recognized testing laboratory.

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Workmanship. The sterilizer shall be clean, well made, and free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One sterilizer, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests, including dimensional test, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-3. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one sterilizer.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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Performance test. One complete twenty minute sterilization cycle shall be run to test for attainment of specified temperature and pressure.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

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Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTES: 1. The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6530-01-132-5426

2. The alcohol-based solution (sterilant) is available under NSN: 6850-00-148-9776.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-2104

Location:
CID/STERILIZER/SURG/INSTRU/H11-30

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51062A	STERILIZER, SURGICAL INSTRUMENT

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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